Votive Dots
Quick guide for Mac

See what every AI agent on your Mac is doing, at a glance.

Votive Dots puts one colored dot in your menu bar for each AI coding agent you have running: Claude Code, Codex, Gemini CLI, Cursor and more. A dot changes color when an agent finishes, needs you or gets stuck, so you can stop checking terminal windows.



One dot for each agent session.
Left to right, in the order they started.

Working
Writing code or running a tool.

Done
Finished and ready for you.

Needs you
Waiting for your answer.

Get it running

You need a Mac with macOS 14 or newer. It takes about two minutes.

1. **Install Node.js.** Get it from nodejs.org, or with Homebrew (free, from brew.sh). Open Terminal and run:

```
$ brew install node
```

2. **Download Votive Dots and unzip it.** Open the latest release on GitHub and download `Votive-Dots-1.8.2-mac.zip`.

```
github.com/kaustubhsawant-it/votive-dots/releases/latest
```

3. **Run the installer from Terminal.** Do not double-click the app: Apple has not notarized it, so macOS refuses it. The installer opens it the right way.

```
$ cd ~/Downloads/Votive-Dots-1.8.2
$ ./Scripts/install.sh
```

4. **Look at the right side of your menu bar.** A small ring appears when no agent is running. Start an agent in a terminal and its dot appears.

5. **Using Codex?** Open it once and approve Votive Dots' hooks by typing `/hooks`. Codex ignores new hooks until you do.

Prefer to build it yourself? The README has the source steps. They need Xcode tools and XcodeGen.

Read the dots

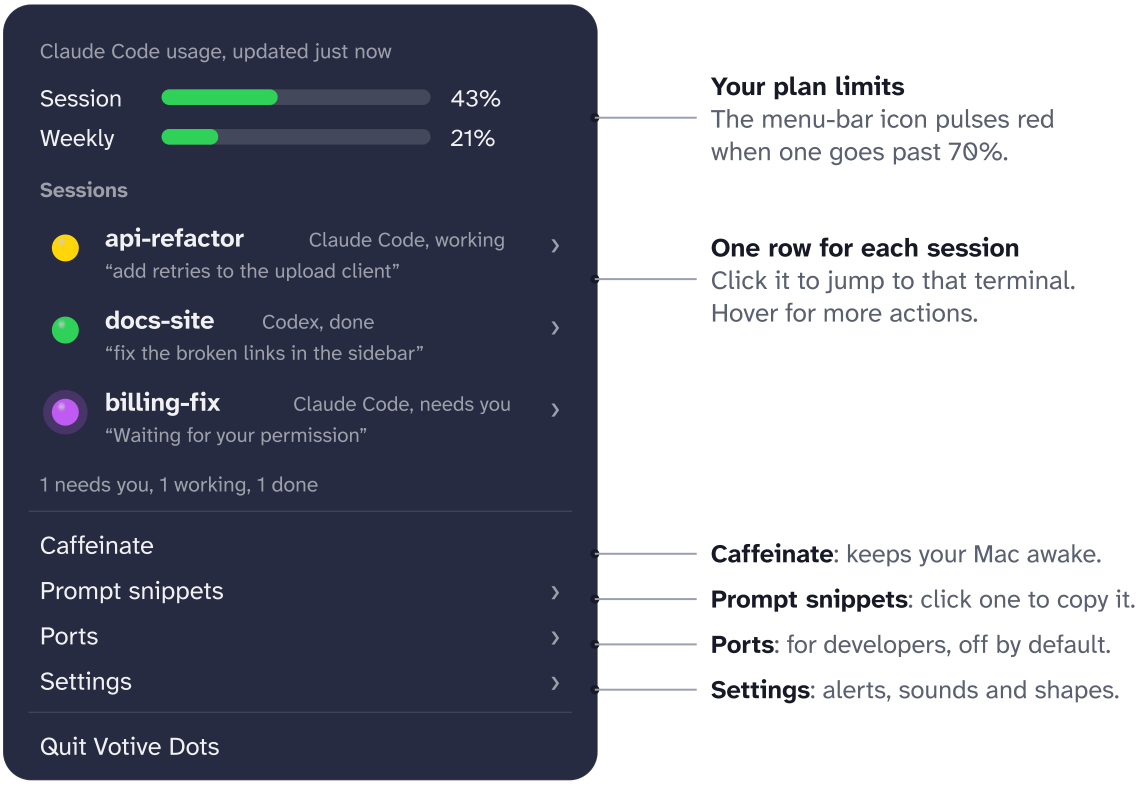
Every dot has a text label in the menu too, so you never have to rely on color alone. A soft ring means the dot pulses on screen.

	State	What it means	What to do
	Starting	A session just opened.	Nothing yet.
	Working	The agent is writing code or running a tool.	Keep going. It will tell you.
	Done	The agent finished and is waiting for you.	Read its answer.
	Needs you	It is asking permission or a question.	Switch to it and answer.
	Error	A step failed, but the session is still alive.	Check what went wrong.
	Stuck	Busy, with no activity for 8 minutes.	Take a look. It may be waiting.
	Stopped	The program crashed or was closed.	Start it again.

Color blind? Turn on **Settings › Colorblind shapes**, and every state also gets its own shape.

Use the menu

Click the dots to open the menu. This is what you will see, with made-up sessions.



Do more with Votive Dots

Get told when a long job finishes

Ask your agent: “Run the tests and let me know when they finish.” In Claude Code you can also type `/notify`. A small panel appears with the agent’s own message.

Keep an eye on your plan limits

The menu shows your session and weekly usage with reset times. Past 70%, the menu-bar icon pulses red and says which limit it is. Claude Code shows this; Codex only sometimes.

Spot an agent that went quiet

A dot turns brown after 8 minutes without activity. Change that under **Settings › Stuck threshold** (Off, 5, 8 or 15 minutes).

Choose how much Votive Dots speaks up

Out of the box it only alerts you when you asked an agent to. Under **Settings › Alerts**, you can add a banner or a pop-up for every change, and pick sounds.

Keep the sessions that matter first

Hover a session and choose **High priority**. It moves to the front of the list, the dots follow, and it keeps its dot even with more than six sessions. Choose **High priority for every session in this folder** and every new session you start in that project is pinned for you. To be alerted *only* about those, turn on **Settings › Alerts › Only alert for high-priority sessions**.

For developers: Ports

Turn it on under **Settings › Developer tools › Ports**. A Ports item appears in the menu.

See. Add ports you care about, such as 3000 or 5173, and see if each is free or in use, and by which program. **All listening ports** lists everything on your Mac that is listening, and who can reach it.

Pause or stop. Pause freezes a program but keeps its port; click again to resume. Stop asks it to quit. Both ask first. They never touch an agent session, Votive Dots itself or a macOS program.

If something looks wrong

No dots appear	Dots only show while an agent session is running. Still nothing? In the `votive` folder run `node Scripts/doctor.js`. It lists what is wrong. Add `--fix` to repair it.
An agent is missing	Run `node Scripts/install-agents.js` after you install a new agent.
macOS asks about Terminal	Click OK. It is how Votive Dots jumps to the right tab. You are asked once.
Votive Dots is not running	Open `~/Applications/Votive.app`. It also starts at every login.
Update or remove it	Update: run `git pull`, then `./Scripts/install.sh` again. Remove: run `./Scripts/uninstall.sh`.

Your data stays on your Mac. Votive Dots has no accounts and no network code. You can check it: the source is short enough to read, and a test fails if networking code is ever added.

Free and open source (MIT license). Source and help: github.com/kaustubhsawant-it/votive-dots. Votive Dots is not made by, or affiliated with, Anthropic, OpenAI, Google, GitHub or Cursor.